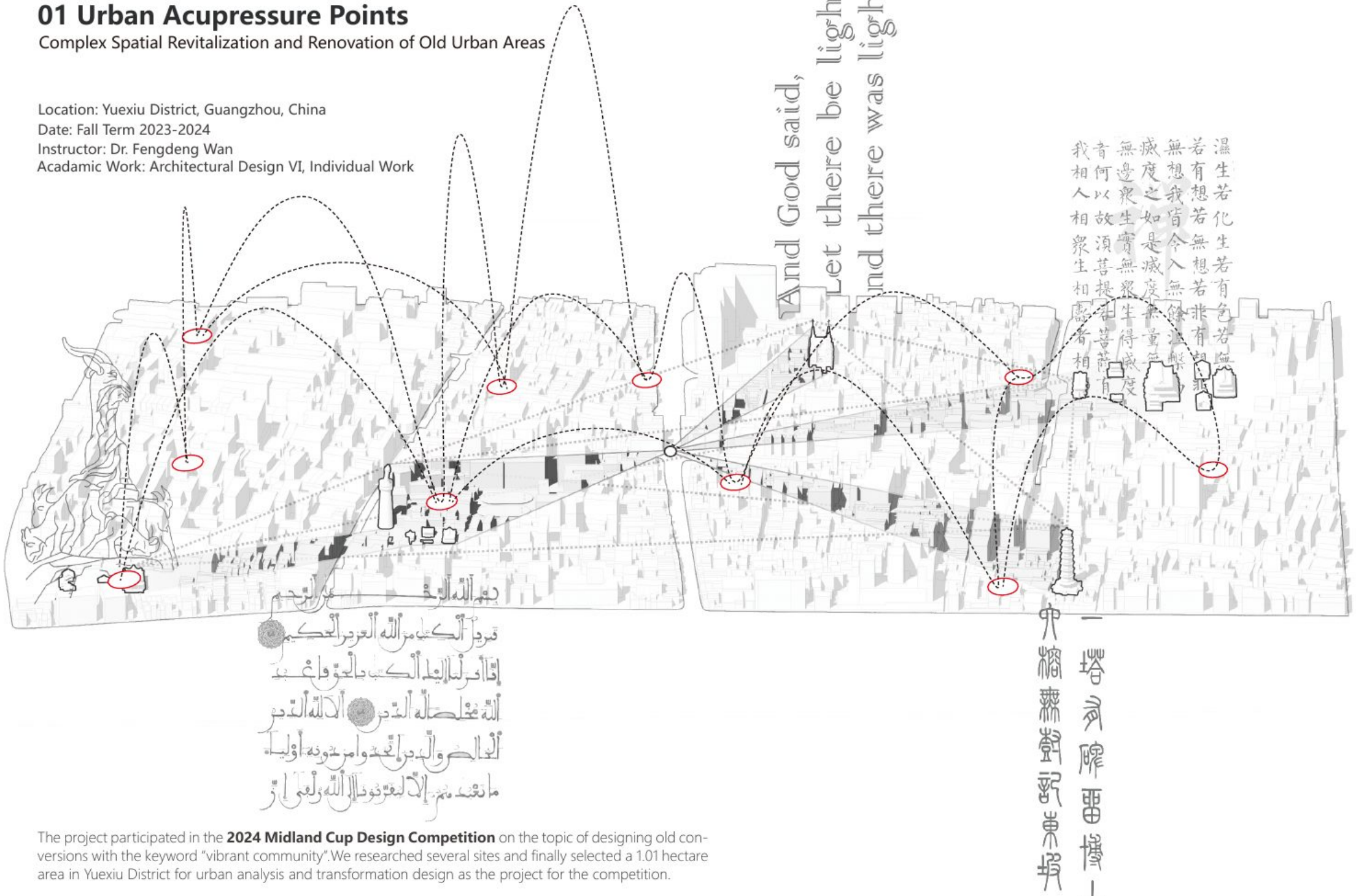
01 Urban Acupressure Points

Complex Spatial Revitalization and Renovation of Old Urban Areas

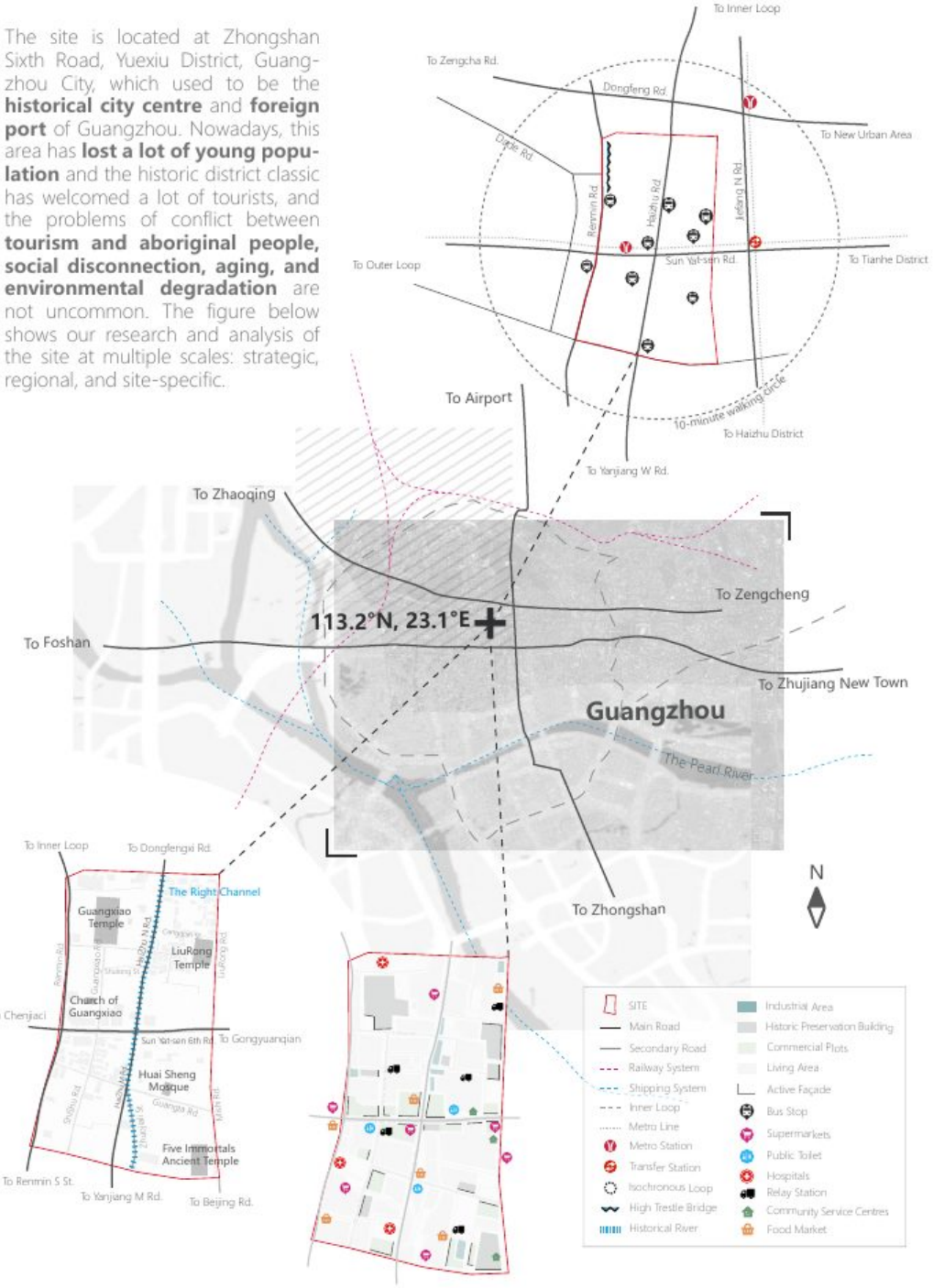
Location: Yuexiu District, Guangzhou, China
Date: Fall Term 2023-2024
Instructor: Dr. Fengdeng Wan
Acadamic Work: Architectural Design VI, Individual Work



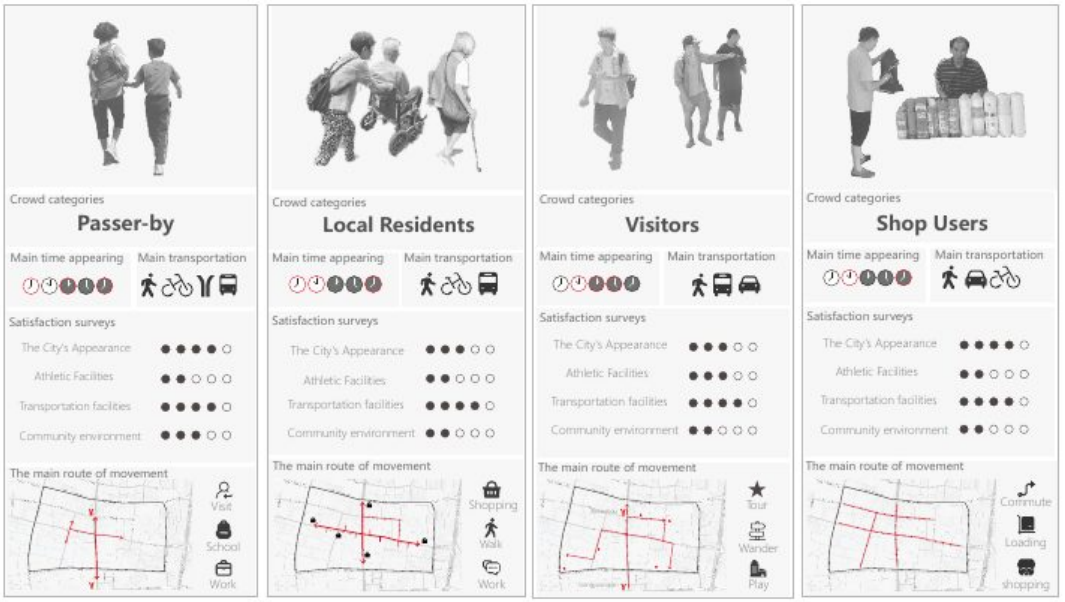
The project participated in the **2024 Midland Cup Design Competition** on the topic of designing old conversions with the keyword "vibrant community".We researched several sites and finally selected a 1.01 hectare area in Yuexiu District for urban analysis and transformation design as the project for the competition.

Site Analysis

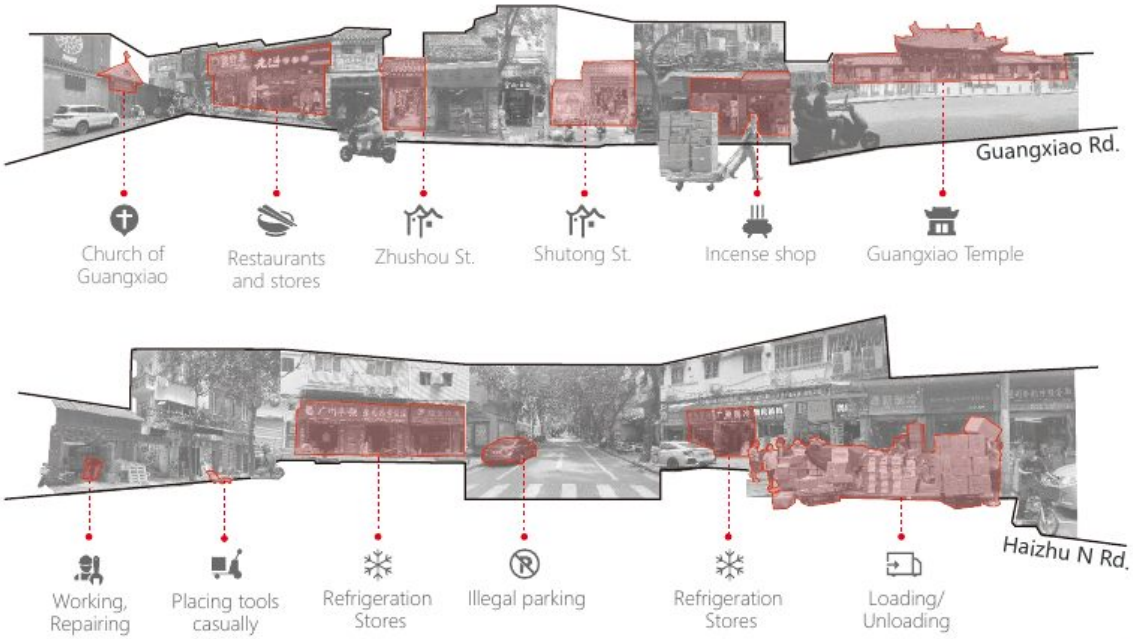
The site is located at Zhongshan Sixth Road, Yuexiu District, Guangzhou City, which used to be the **historical city centre** and **foreign port** of Guangzhou. Nowadays, this area has **lost a lot of young population** and the historic district classic has welcomed a lot of tourists, and the problems of conflict between **tourism and aboriginal people, social disconnection, aging, and environmental degradation** are not uncommon. The figure below shows our research and analysis of the site at multiple scales: strategic, regional, and site-specific.



Crowd Surveys



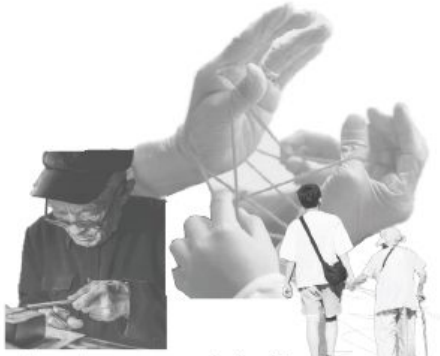
Block Composition



Logical Introduction



Reform and opening up, monetization of shanty-town reform, and a large number of young people flock to the city.



How to get young people back? On the basis of family affection, it is more important to establish production relations and tap the relationship between supply and demand.



With the development of e-commerce, under the policy of **the Belt and Road** Initiative, economic conditions permit, **Made in China — the national is the world.**

Urban employment has almost reached saturation, and phenomena such as **Empty Nesters, Left-behind Children** and **Silver-haired Addiction** are frequent.



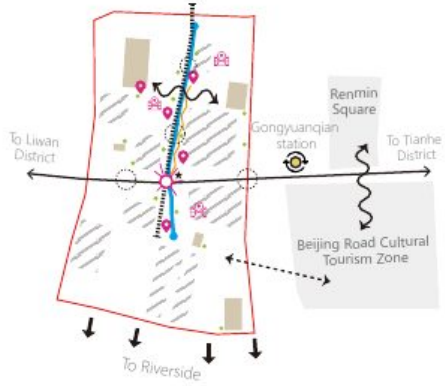
Through the cultural inheritance of **bringing the old with the new**, the intangible cultural heritage is transformed into modern product output.



A Missing Chapter

objective assessment and corresponding strategies

Design Considerations



Opportunities

- The site
- Historic Listed Area
- Developed Green Space
- Existing Culverts
- Potential Sports Squares
- Existing School's Playground
- Main Transport Hub
- Main Transport Connection
- Existing Strong Connection
- Potential Enhancing Connection
- Key View
- Historic Listed Trees

Constraints

- Potential Unsafe Interations
- Potential Unsafe blocks
- Dense living area
- Barrier
- High-rise Buildings

Objectives & Actions

A



Focusing on the feelings of Cantonese people about the **banyan tree**, the node installation is explored under the banyan tree, and the space under the tree is used.

B



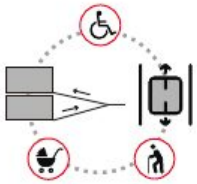
Let the old man with the best skills have the desire to pass it on, **provide employment for the young people**, and establish the production relationship between the two.

C



The surplus income obtained through operation can be used to **feed back** the initial cost of construction & subsequent maintenance, forming a virtuous circle.

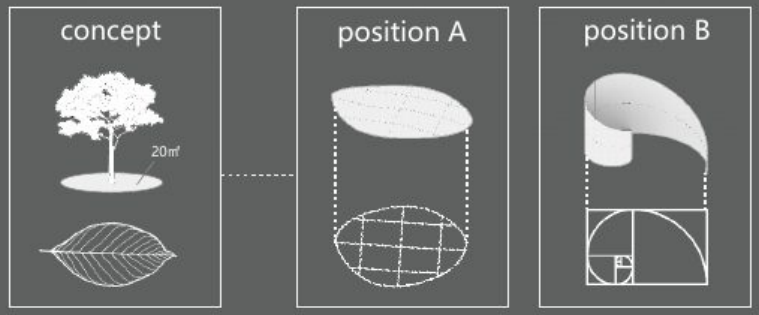
D



Considering the composition of the community, we should have a **humanistic spirits** and care for social workers like Sanitation workers, disabled people, stray cats and dogs, etc.

Community Activity System

About the organization of the nodes and the age-appropriate design of the block

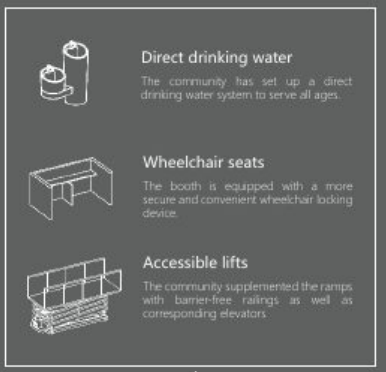


• Community recreation

The Leisure and Shelter nodes will provide a more comfortable roaming experience for the entire community.

• Sporty atmosphere

The sports nodes offer a variety of terrain that attracts neighborhood sports enthusiasts, where sports competitions can be held.



Direct drinking water

The community has set up a direct drinking water system to serve all ages.

Wheelchair seats

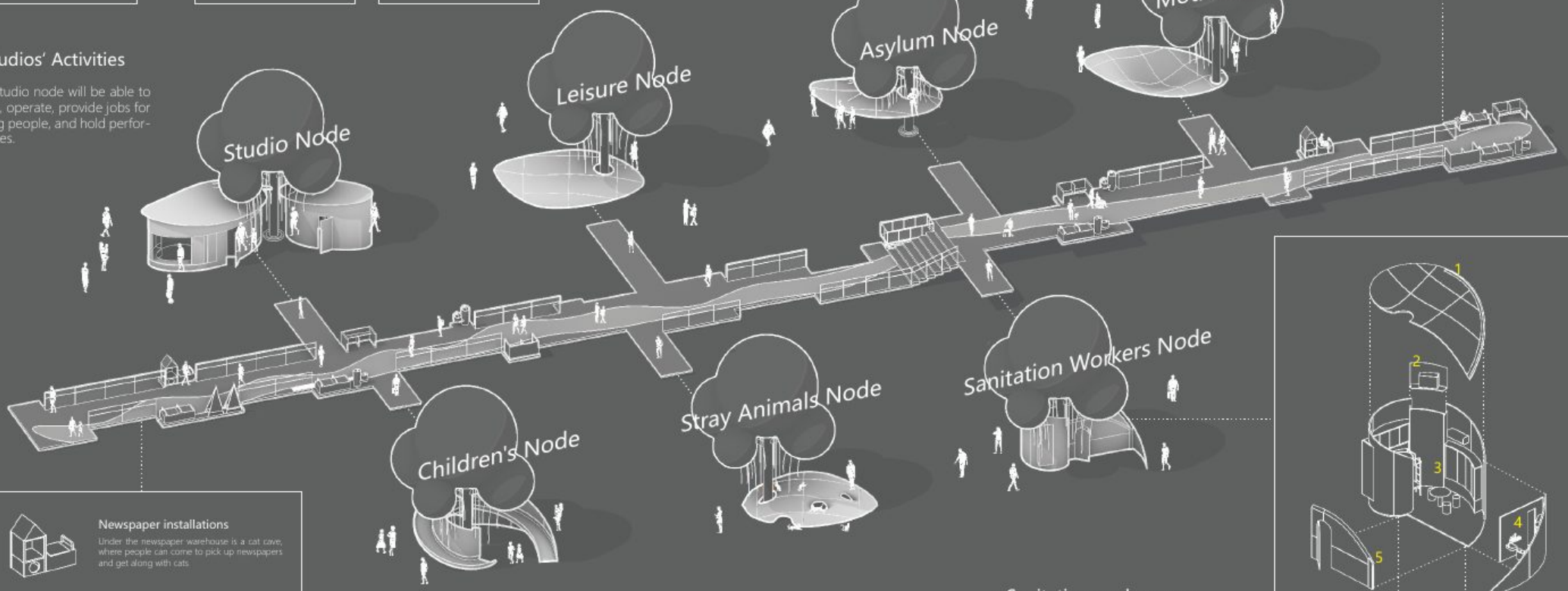
The booth is equipped with a more secure and convenient wheelchair locking device.

Accessible lifts

The community supplemented the ramps with barrier-free railings as well as corresponding elevators.

• Studios' Activities

The studio node will be able to teach, operate, provide jobs for young people, and hold performances.





Newspaper installations

Under the newspaper warehouse is a cat cave, where people can come to pick up newspapers and get along with cats.

Dog walking lounge

There are many people walking their dogs in the community, and there is also a short rest place for the dogs.

Age-friendly seats

The chairs are equipped with upholstery and armrests.

• Children's activities

Children can play here after school, and there are plenty of facilities and a variety of games.

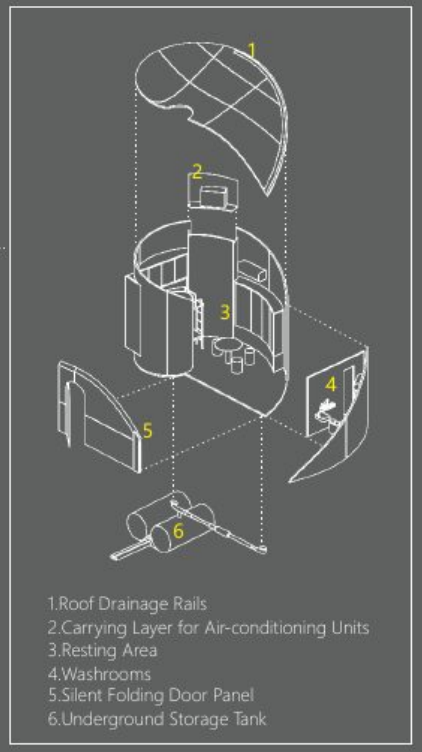
• Live stream interactions

The live broadcast can be connected to the feeding of stray cats and dogs, and the profits obtained can be fed back to the maintenance of the device to achieve a good operation cycle.



• Sanitation workers care

Dedicated nodes provide living conditions where hard-working community sanitation workers can take short breaks.



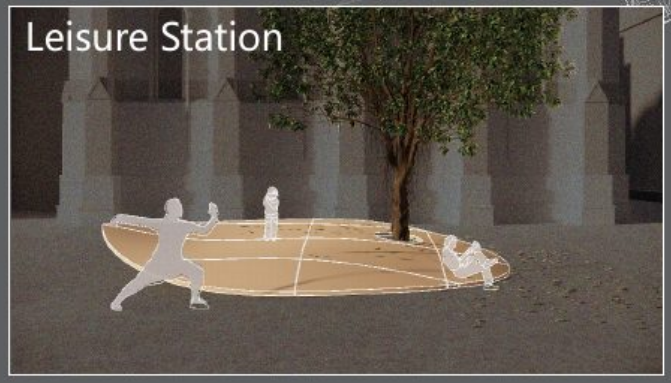
1.Roof Drainage Rails
2.Carrying Layer for Air-conditioning Units
3.Resting Area
4.Washrooms
5.Silent Folding Door Panel
6.Underground Storage Tank


Cultural Center


Workers' Rest Area


Children's Park


Tongning Alley Community
Church of Guangxiao
Zhushou Alley Community
Guangxiao Temple
Guangxiao Rd Community
Renmin Mid Community
Guangdong Zhiyong School
Guangzhou Trade Vocational High School
Liurong Temple
Waisheng Mosque
Fuquan Community
Progress Lane Community
Wuxianguan Daoist temple


Leisure Station


Animal Room


Sports Corner